

Build a WordPress Web Application Using WAMP



WordPress can be used to build a free website or a blog. It boasts of hundreds of free designs and templates for your website, and is one of the world's best content management systems (CMS). You don't need to be a professional to set it up. In this article, the author gives a tutorial on setting up a simple WordPress site with WAMP.

Before installing WordPress on a desktop, it's necessary to also have a local server environment on it. Let's use the WAMP server to install WordPress on a Windows computer. If you want to have a live WordPress site available to the public, then you need to have a domain and WordPress Web hosting, for that's where you can transfer your site to later from your local server. Average users can use the local server environment to test plugins or make changes to the site before making it live for their audiences.

The WAMP server

WAMP or WampServer is a virtual server for the Windows platform. The acronym stands for Windows Apache MySQL PHP. It allows the management of a website and all its components. The advantage with this software is that it deals with three different website formats, which are MySQL, PHP and Apache. WAMP is free and can be easily downloaded from <http://www.wampserver.com/en/>

Installing WAMP on your desktop

Once the WampServer is downloaded, run the installation program and follow the on-screen instructions. At one point during the installation, WampServer will ask for the location of the default Web browser. By default, it will use Internet Explorer, but you can change that to Google Chrome or Firefox by locating the browser in *Program Files*. When the installation is done, just launch the WampServer. Once that's done, you get

two modules—one is Apache and the other is MySQL; so just start both modules. Once these modules start working, check out your server by opening the URL <http://localhost/>.

Installing WordPress on a WAMP server

Before installing WordPress, let's build a database for our WordPress site. There is one Web application module called *phpMyAdmin* in WampServer, which is used to manage MySQL databases. Just open it by clicking on the *WampServer* icon in the Windows taskbar, and then click on *phpmyadmin*.

Enter the name of your database here, like *wordpress_db* and just click on the *Create* button to create a database of your WordPress application. Now it's time to install WordPress. We can download a copy of WordPress from <https://wordpress.org/>.

Extract the Zip file and there you will find a copy of WordPress in it; just copy the WordPress folder and paste it in *C:\wamp\www*.

Open your first WordPress website by using the URL <http://localhost/wordpress/>.

- 1) The first thing you will see is a prompt to select the language for your site. So let's choose the language and click on *Continue*.
- 2) Next, you will see the *Welcome* screen of WordPress, where we are informed that we have to know the database name, user name, password and the host name before going further.